- Vitamin C is required as coenzyme for the enzyme dopamine hydroxylase which catalyzes the conversion of dopamine to nor-epinephrine.
- It is involved in the maturation of red blood cells.
- The absorption of iron is significantly enhanced by the presence of vitamin C.
- It has a general antioxidant role , especially in the regeneration of oxidized vitamin E in membranes.

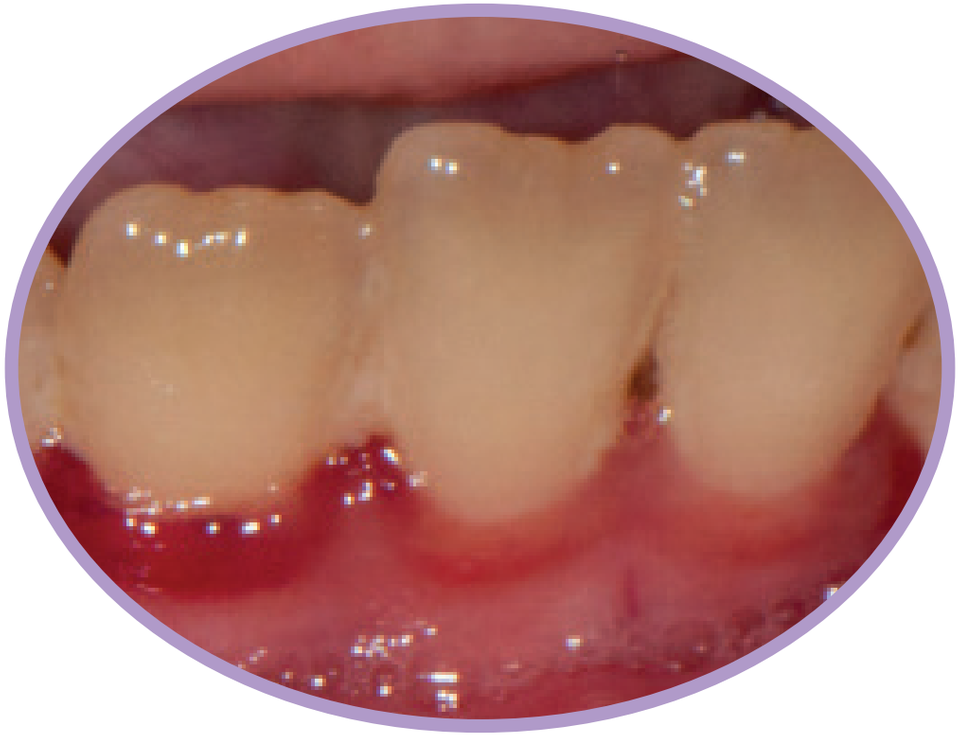


Fig. 8.31 Deficiency due to vitamin C

Absorption and storage

Ascorbic acid is rapidly absorbed from the intestines and passed on through the portal vein to the general circulation. Vitamin C is found in highest concentrations in the adrenals, the pituitary and retina than in circulation. Excessive intake of the vitamin do not increase beyond the optimal levels.

Deficiency:

Scurvy is the classical syndrome of vitamin C deficiency. It is related to defective collagen synthesis which is indicated by fragile skin, muscle weakness, bleeding of the gums, loose teeth and delayed wound healing.

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